The Evolve Avatar Training

Definition:

Avatar: A group of specific people most likely to buy your product.

Goal: Create *instant* relatability - when they read your ad, they think "that's exactly me."

Why Relatability Matters: When people feel like you really get them, they trust you. When they trust you, they buy your stuff.

The Problem With Avatars:
For most brands, Avatars, ICPs (Ideal customer profiles), or Personas are just demographic-based & generalized profiles that you create once because someone in marketing told you they were important.

You may think about them once or twice when making ads, but very rarely do people actually think through an Avatar when writing ads.

And that is the biggest problem.

Most Avatars are NOT actionable.

But the truth is, you are actually targeting Avatars with every single ad you write.

No matter what you write, you are targeting an Avatar.

The problem is, the Avatar you're targeting is usually super broad. And it’s not relatable. Which is why most people suck at making ads.

This Avatar training is going to completely shift your mindset around Avatars. It will help you create Avatars that don’t suck & are ACTUALLY actionable in every single one of your ads.

What This Training Will Cover:
It will teach you how to build an Avatar that you put into ACTION.

You will learn how to identify what your Avatar wants, figure out what they've been through, understand how they feel, learn what they do, and optimize it for your ads.

Okay, So… What is an Avatar for eCommerce?

An “Avatar,” as mentioned above, is also known as:

- Persona, Customer Persona, Buyer Persona, User Persona
- ICP (Ideal Customer Profile), Customer Profile, Buyer Profile
- Target Audience, Target Market, Target Demographic
- Etc.

They all mean the same thing.

But what an Avatar really is, is a group of people who are unified by similar things.

“What things?” - Those we will get into very shortly.

But your Avatar is at the CORE of your creative strategy.

Whether you are aware of it or not, you are targeting an Avatar with every single ad creative you make.

However, “Common” and “Broad” Avatars have become extremely sophisticated in eCommerce.

Meaning the most common avatars that EVERYONE thinks of are already being called out and sold to.

And due to how competitive eCommerce is and the fact that it gets more competitive every single day, most people fail to make creatives that work because they call out the same Avatar as everyone else is, with the SAME mechanisms & information everyone else has.

Which means the only way you actually succeed when targeting broad avatars is: 1. You have a great product with NEW mechanisms, 2. You are able to educate people & provide them NEW information, or you have the BEST offer in your market. We already talked about the first 2, and we can talk about the offers another time.

But, by having a clear Avatar, it tells you what to say in your ads, how to say it, what emotions to trigger, and how to make strangers feel like your product was made specifically just for them EVEN if you don’t have anything incredibly new or moving.

Meta targeting is now done 99% by the actual creative. Not the audience you select at the adset level*.

***This is an exaggerated claim, but Meta is now much more creative based than “Button clicking” based.**

So, if you want to target an avatar, it has to be done through the creative. Not by selecting interest on Meta.

Meta also rewards relevance.

Which means the MORE your creative resonates with your specific avatar, the lower your costs will be and the higher your conversions.

In short, identifying and building a proper avatar is how you actually scale in modern-day eCommerce

🫠**If you're still stuck on Avatars.**

My favorite way to explain Avatars is "memes" or "relatable videos" online.

If you are going through this document, you have likely watched a TikTok or Instagram reel or had a friend send you something that was "relatable".

Why was it relatable?

Because that video called out a specific Avatar

And you identified with it.

And as a result, you probably laughed at it or said

"That is definitely me."

What Does an Avatar Consist of?

Now, before we get in, I want you to understand that this take on avatars is something that I personally have never seen anybody talk about.

So this is likely going to be brand new to most of you.

Because it was brand new to me when writing it.

Now, before we get into what an avatar consists of, it is important to understand that Avatars exist on a **scale** that has essentially **infinite combinations.**

Meaning…

You can create avatars so SPECIFIC, it alienates a single person.

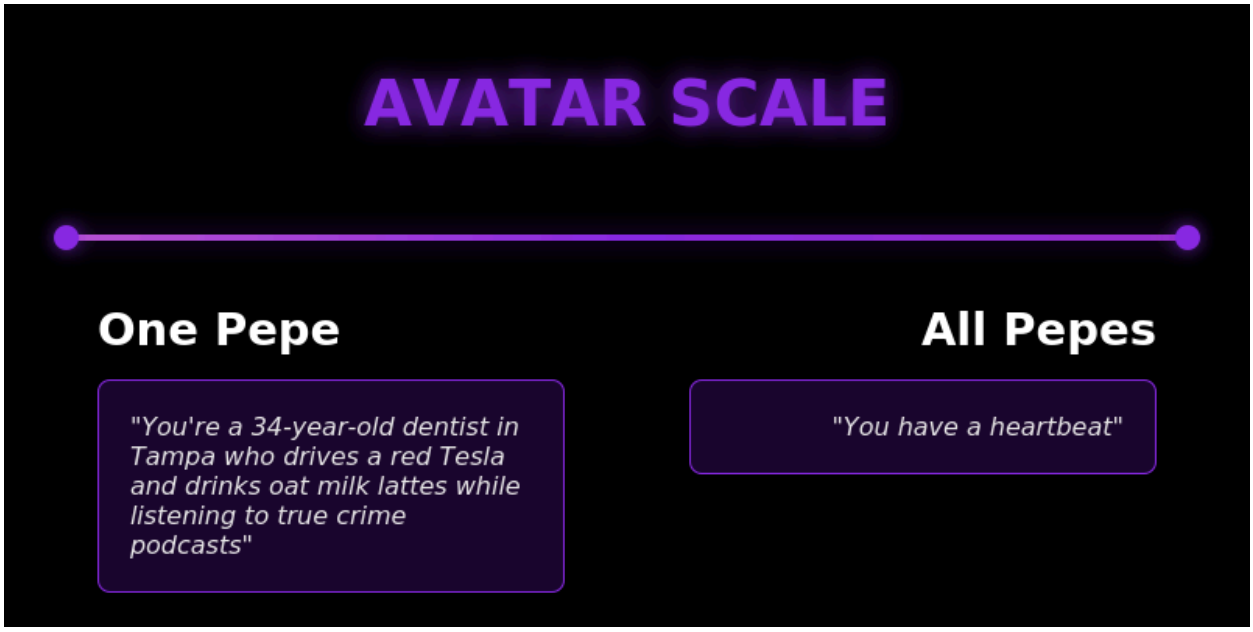
Yet on the other side of the scale

You can create avatars so BROAD, it includes everyone

This relationship is what nerds would call “more linear.”

AKA, it’s very simple for most people to understand, as it is very clear.

On one side of the spectrum, we have very specific, and on the other side of the spectrum, we have very broad.



As you can see, based on the graphic above.

On one side, we have:

🐸**One Pepe** ***(person)*** → Meaning this is a very specific avatar and is likely a very small group of people or even a single person

And then on the other side:

🐸🐸🐸**All Pepes** ***(People)*** → Meaning this is a very broad avatar and is likely a very large group of people

Simple.

Now this next part is where things get more complex, but again, we will be able to simplify it.

The other component of this is the **infinite combination** side of things.

The reason this gets complex is that the “infinite combinations” side of things is what nerds would call “more non-linear”.

Meaning, you have an infinite number of Avatars that you can create & place on the scale.

And although complex, this is actually a GOOD thing.

If there are essentially infinite combinations of Avatars…

That means there will ALWAYS be untapped combinations (aka Avatars) that you can target 😀

So, how do you create these Avatars?

Let’s get into it.

How To Create Core Avatars

I have developed what I am calling the **Core 5 categories**, in which you can group people to create avatars.

To reference the language above, you can pull from each of these 5 categories to “make a combination”. **Again, just to be clear, by combination, I mean avatar.**

To make an avatar that doesn’t suck, you must understand that the order of these categories is what matters most for building EFFECTIVE Avatars.

Effective Avatars are avatars that SCALE and MAKE YOU MONEY.

The coolest part about how this training shows you how to build Avatars is that you can have avatars that have **zero mentions of demographics**

YA. COOL RIGHT?

(Okay, maybe it’s just me who thinks that is cool)

So, with traditional “Avatar building strategies”

People ALWAYS start with demographics.

And that’s why most people suck at making Avatars & never use them.

So, if you want to create Avatars that your competition is not, and more importantly, Avatars that make you a ton of cash…

You then need to focus on the top categories first.

And actually use demographics LAST.

The reason this gives you an advantage in the market and also helps you create specific Avatars that are more scalable is that you are not alienating people based on logistics.

And if you don't alienate people just based on their demographics, it opens up a larger opportunity for you to scale and have more success by things that ACTUALLY drive real purchase intent.

📝 RULES OF THUMB:

Avoid combining more than one Desire when building your Avatar.

The more of these categories you use, the more specific your Avatar will be.

The fewer categories you use, the less specific your Avatar will be.

The more BROAD your Avatar is: The better your product, offer, brand, and marketing skillset have to be to get conversions

The more SPECIFIC *but not ALIENATING* your Avatar is: The worse your product, offer, brand, and marketing skillset can be to get conversions*
This does not mean sell a shit product. It means if you have nothing "insanely innovative" about your product, aka it's more sophisticated, you need to have a more specific avatar to build trust.

‼Keep in mind that these categories are ways for you to group people into "Avatars" based on commonalities they have.

Through a lot of head scratching, back & forth, and proof checking with AI, I have been able to simplify this down into **5 CATEGORIES**. There is NO REASON to complicate it more than that for your Avatars.

We will be able to get into more specifics ONCE we have a Core Avatar defined.

Let's begin:

Category 1: Desires

Desires are the "I want/I need" statements that you've already been hunting for.

To be clear, grouping people by the CORE DESIRE is not recommended for building avatars, as those are too broad.

And again, the broader your avatar, the better everything else has to be, as mentioned in the RULES OF THUMB above.

Now, it is STILL very important that you understand the CORE DESIRE of the more surface-level desires that you find through research.

However, for the sake of building avatars initially, I recommend using more surface-level desires because they are more specific and help build better avatars.

For brands at a larger scale *($500k+/month)* you can leverage the core desires as a starting point if you choose:

For example:
"I want to be healthier" (Health)
"I want more status" (Status)
etc.

But again, these are very BROAD human desires that almost every single person has and require a lot more heavy lifting on product, offer, brand, skillset, and MORE specific combinations from the other 4 categories below.

!!VERY IMPORTANT
You should always start your Avatar creation process with a DESIRE over a demographic.

Desire-first Avatars are stronger than demographic-first Avatars due to the emotional pull that desires have. AKA desires drive stronger purchase behavior than demographics alone, as I mentioned above.

Examples Of Surface-Level Desires:

a. I want to get better sleep *(Core Desire: Health)*
b. I want my dog to stop pulling *(Core Desire: Control/Comfort/Status)*
c. I need to lose this baby fat *(Core Desire: Health/Status)*
d. I want to be in control of my body *(Core Desire:Control/Health)*
e. I want to perform better in the bedroom (*Core Desire: Sex/Control)*

As you can see, a lot of these surface-level desires actually may attend to multiple core desires depending on the context.

This is why you must HAVE an understanding of CORE DESIRES as well.

And if possible, in your research, try to dig even deeper to understand the “Why” behind the surface-level desire, as that will reveal what the core desire actually is.

But… By using the other 4 categories below, I'm going to show you how you will be able to actually identify WHICH core desires based on the experiences, emotions, and behaviors that exist 👀

💥 HOW TO CHECK IT’S A DESIRE 💥

Underneath each section, I will have a checker that will give you a formula to be able to check whether or not you actually have the specific thing in the category.

The reason being, is that categorizing things for the first time can be hard.

So, your “formula” / “checker” to make sure that you actually HAVE a desire, is to use the “I want X…” or “I need Y…” statement.

If you can’t say that in a sentence, it’s not a desire.

For example:
When doing research, someone says, *“Why does it take so long to brush your teeth?”*

The desire you could pull from this is:

“I want to brush my teeth faster.”

There you go, now you have a desire.

With that said, finding desires is pretty simple. If you need more support on Desires, go back and watch the Desire training in Step 2.

Category 2: Experiences

Experiences are situations that people have gone through in the past or are currently going through.

For effective avatar building, experiences are split into 2 categories:

1. Situational Experiences - Circumstances or situations the person is in or has gone through

<u>Example:</u>
- Bedroom gets very bright in the morning
- Dog pulls on walks
- Had a baby
- Lived in a small apartment with thin walls
- Got divorced two years ago

Again, these experiences could be ACTIVE (which usually creates more urgency if it is a problem) or they could be long in the PAST (which usually creates more relatability through nostalgia)

2. Product-Based Experiences: Experiences where a solution/product was tried and a specific outcome resulted.

- Tried blackout curtains and still woke up tired
- Used a dog harness and it didn't work
- Lost 30 pounds on keto diet but gained it back
- Hired a contractor and got burned

🌟Crucial thing here 🌟

For this category in general, but especially with product experiences, we need to focus specifically on <u>WHAT</u> is happening.

As much as we can “assume a desire” and we can “assume an emotion” or “assume a behavior” as a result of the outcome.

For the sake of CORE AVATARS, we need to ISOLATE the experience.

‼**Try to avoid including:**‼

A. What they WANT as a result → *That is their desire*
B. Not HOW they feel about it → *That is their emotions (more on this later)*
C. Not their RESPONSE to it → *That is their behaviors (more on this later*)

So for the product-based experiences above:

- Tried blackout curtains and still woke up tired

This has an IMPLIED ***Desire*** that the person wants to sleep better (but it's not 100% true)
This also has an implied ***Emotion*** that the person is frustrated
This also has an implied ***Behavior*** that the person is looking for a better way to sleep

But for this section, we ONLY CARE about WHAT is happening or WHAT happened.

We will tie in Desire, Emotion, and Behavior and everything else below

I promise, it will be awesome.

NOW …

The point of experiences in the context of creating core avatars is that they unite people because they have "been through the same thing" or are actively "going through the same thing"

Many people have a LOT of shared experiences.

Many people have

"Been To Disneyland" → **Experience**

But everything else that comes AFTER that experience:

- How they *feel* about it *(Emotion)*
- Their *response* to it → *(Behaviors)*

Is how we narrow avatars down even further, and we will do that in our NEXT STEPS.

But because I can't help myself, here is an example of a Situational Experience

<u>Situation Experience Example:</u>
Core Avatar: Someone who went to Disneyland → This is an Avatar JUST based on an experience

Sub Avatar #1: Someone who went to Disneyland and feels that it is overrated → *This is an Avatar narrowed down by emotion*

Sub Avatar #2: Someone who went to Disneyland and feels like there is no better place in the world → *This is ALSO an Avatar narrowed down by emotion*

And by understanding that, we can use them to our advantage.

Now, most of you guys don't run ads for Disneyland lol…

BUT, we can use "analogies" to draw comparisons *(a strategy we will touch on at some point)* to build reliability with either of those Avatars based on "what our product is like"

We could say:
"It's like going to Disneyland every day" → and that would REALLY resonate with Sub Avatar #2.

We could also say:
"It's like if Disneyland was actually fun." → That would likely resonate with Sub Avatar #1.

This is a CRAZY example, but I want you guys to start thinking about HOW you can group based on experiences and narrow down using the other 4 categories to build relatability.

Even though we haven't covered emotions yet….

So because of that

🧘🧘🧘🧘🧘**Let's take a quick little breather…** 🧘🧘🧘🧘🧘

Remember, if you're feeling uncomfortable

Or you're confused

Or you have no idea what's going on

That's a good thing.

Because you're learning something new

And your body just rejects change at first because it likes to feel safe

And the more you study this

The more it will stick

If you're loving this and it's making sense.

You're dialed.

Either way

Let's keep rocking

😮‍💨 😮‍💨 😮‍💨 😮‍💨 **And we're back** 😮‍💨 😮‍💨 😮‍💨 😮‍💨

Now, if we remember, experience is just "1" of the core 5 categories.

To start making "Sub Avatars" (aka more effective Avatars), you can start combining DESIRES and EXPERIENCES to create even more effective Avatars that build relatability.

(Kind of like how we just did it above with the Disneyland example)

<u>Example Of Desires + Experiences For Avatar Building:</u>

Desire: Wants their cat to be healthy

Experience: Cat is excessively licking its paws

🧪 *Pop Quiz… Is this a product experience or a situation experience?* 🧪

This is a situational experience!!

<u>Avatars</u>

Core Avatar #1: Wants their cat to be healthy (The desire → obviously very broad)

Core Avatar #2: Notices their cat is excessively licking paws (The Experience)

Sub Avatar #1: Wants their cat to be healthy, but notices the cat is licking its paws

Now again, just like in the Disneyland example, we can use JUST the experience itself from above to actually create a core avatar. We don't have to tie it back to a desire.

That said, it's safe to say we can assume that EVERY person (at least I hope) has the desire for their cat to be healthy lol

With that said, the reason why I list the experience-only core avatar is that sometimes the desire is not always obvious behind the experience

In the "Went to Disneyland" example

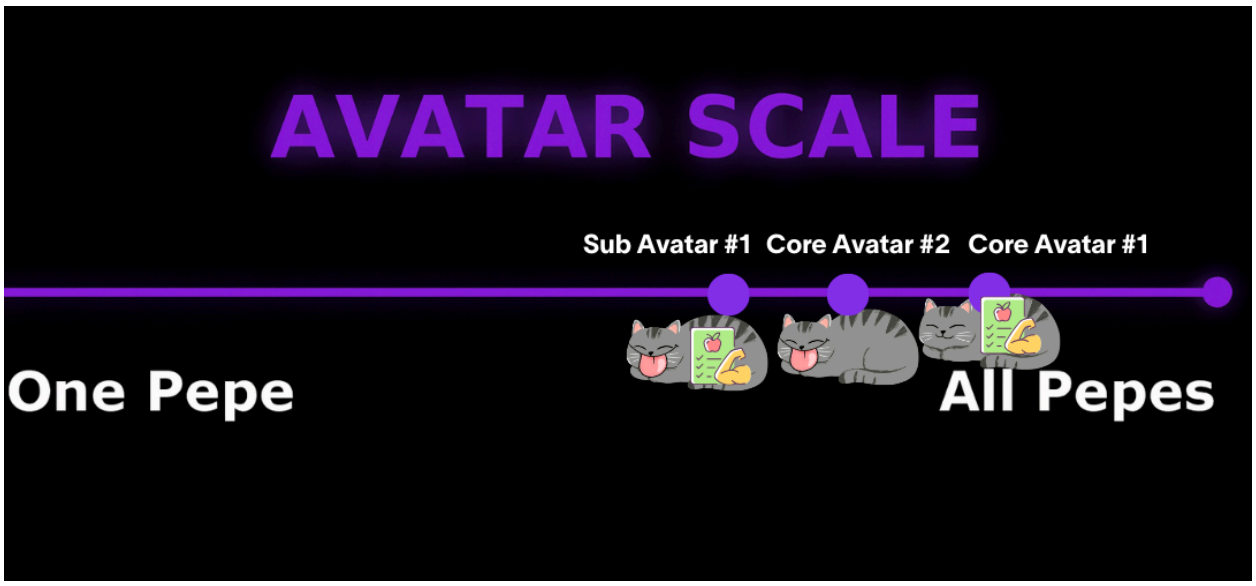
The desire underneath that could have been a ton of different things:

- Want to create memories for their kids *(Belonging)*
- Want to relive their own childhood nostalgia *(Comfort)*
- Want to take Instagram-worthy photos *(Status)*

So as you can see, experiences can be used as the INITIAL building block for core avatars and then narrowed down further based on the actual desire.

With that said, coming back to the main point here around the “Healthy Cat” desire and “Paw licking” as you can see by adding the EXPERIENCE to the DESIRE, we have an avatar that is MORE specific on our spectrum.

Here is how it would look on the scale:



I added a tongue to the cat… It’s supposed to be licking its paws lol

Now, again, keep in mind, the majority of people probably want their cat to be healthy lol.

But with that said, there might be some people that just don't care about their cat at all. So, that's why there's a potential gap. But at the end of the day, hopefully, as you can see, by taking the desire and the experience, we were able to make a more specific avatar.

<u>Example Of Desires + Product Experiences For Avatar Building:</u>

So, as you saw above, we were discussing situational experiences. Now, let’s talk about avatar building with a product experience

Desire: Want to sleep better

Experience: Tried magnesium, and it didn't work

Remember that product experiences will always have an outcome.

EVEN if the outcome is “I’m still trying it” or “I’m still testing it” that is the outcome.

Now let's build the Avatars:

<u>Avatars</u>

Core Avatar #1: Want to sleep better (The Desire)

Core Avatar #2: Tried, magnesium didn't work (The Experience)

Sub Avatar #1: Want to sleep better, but magnesium doesn't work

Now, If you've ever wondered why market sophistication exists, it's because of experiences across the masses… EVEN if the experiences are INDIRECT, meaning *"We know someone who tried a dog harness and it didn't work"*

Those are called "Direct experiences" VS "Indirect experiences" but you don't need to get confused on those.

At the end of the day, we are focused on experiences here, and as you can see, again we have 2 core avatars and 1 sub avatar.

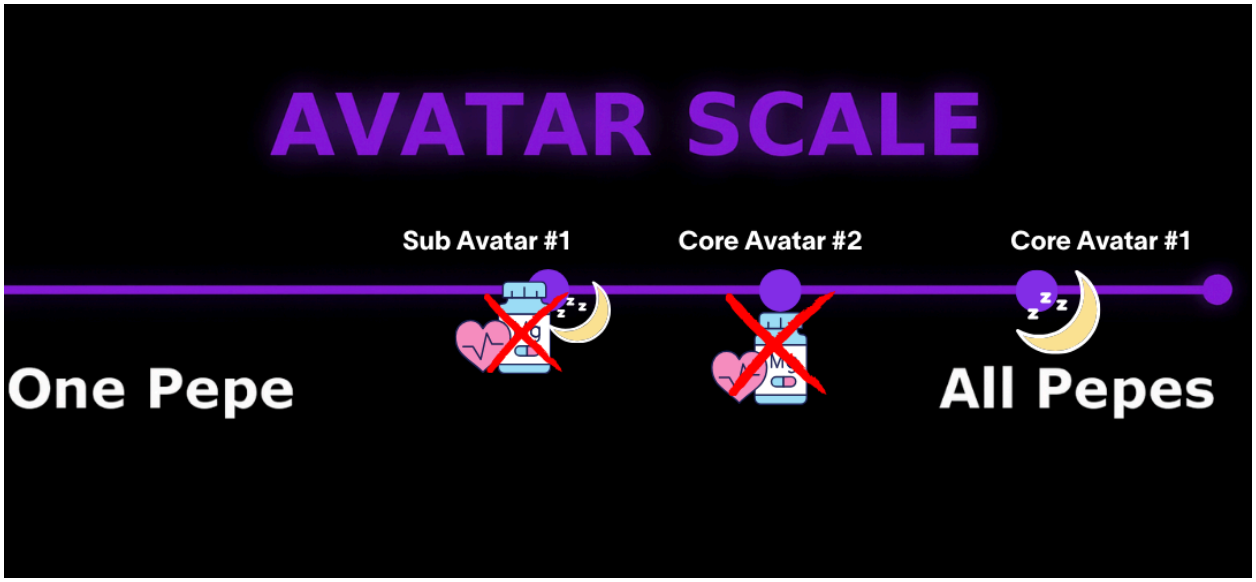
However, In this example, we have a product experience that actually has MULTIPLE benefits which means it can lead to MULTIPLE desires

Magnesium is studied to help with benefits like

- Migraines
- Bone health
- Heart health
- High blood pressure
- Anxiety
- Sleep disorder
- Improves mood

Therefore, it's important to understand the product experience <u>specifically</u> to actually figure out how you want to niche your avatar down if you choose to go based on just the experience

Here is how this could look on our Avatar scale:



Now again, it's important to understand that you do the research to identify how many people actually say, for example, magnesium doesn't work, versus how many people say it doesn't work for sleep, versus how many people actually want sleep rather than just assuming, but you get the point.

<u>Final Context On Experiences</u>

Experiences often lead to the creation of desires, behaviors, and emotions (which are 3 of the other 4 categories for building avatars)

But, on top of that, they also enhance market sophistication, build belief systems, create identities, and do a LOT MORE.

So, although we are getting deep here, it's important to understand that experiences essentially shape everything about us.

Kind of crazy.

But also kind of cool.

This is by far the longest and the most complex section.

With that said, experiences are an extremely powerful way to create relatability with users (whether it's product or situational)

However, when they are paired WITH desires & the other core 5 categories to build Sub-Avatars

It can crush.

💥 HOW TO CHECK IT'S AN EXPERIENCE 💥

Experiences can be tricky as they are literally what shape 90% of our existence.

That said, here is the 2-question test to ensure you have JUST an experience.

Experience Test:
Does this describe a circumstance or event?
Did we remove the EMOTION from it?

Examples:
✅ Pure Experiences:
"Just had a baby" (situation that happened)
"Lives in a noisy apartment" (current circumstance)
"Tried Ozempic and it worked" (product experience)

❌ Not Pure Experiences:
"Wants to have another baby after having a new baby" (Experience + desire → "Wants to have")
"Hates living in a noisy apartment" (includes experience + emotion → "Hates…")

The demographic overlap is fine - "just had a baby" naturally implies female demographics, which is realistic.

All of this will make a lot more sense after we go through the core 5.

I'm just trying to help you see the CORE of what is happening first.

Category 3: Emotions

Emotions are how people feel or states they enter as a result of the experiences, desires, and behaviors they have.

Emotions are complicated. But we're going to simplify them.

If you take anything away from this training, just know emotions are how people FEEL about what is happening

Remember, the goal of this category is to build relatability with our Avatar. Not to be a therapist.

That said, in marketing, emotions are one of the most powerful ways to group people (aka create Avatars) as they strike us differently than typical "facts" or experiences.

Emotions a lot of the time can bypass logical thinking.

Most people "logically" would not slash someone else's tires…

But when emotions are high *(for example from a breakup)* then all of a sudden, slashing tires doesn't seem like a terrible idea to someone who is very emotional.

Emotions can create instant 'that's me' recognition in people and can make certain people feel even more emotions as a result.

By using emotion alongside experiences, behaviors, desires, or demographics, you are able to narrow down avatars and create a lot more relatability.

Now, it's important to understand that 2 TYPES of Emotions exist

1. **Primary Emotions - Simple, universal, feel them the exact same way for everyone, & happen in the moment.**

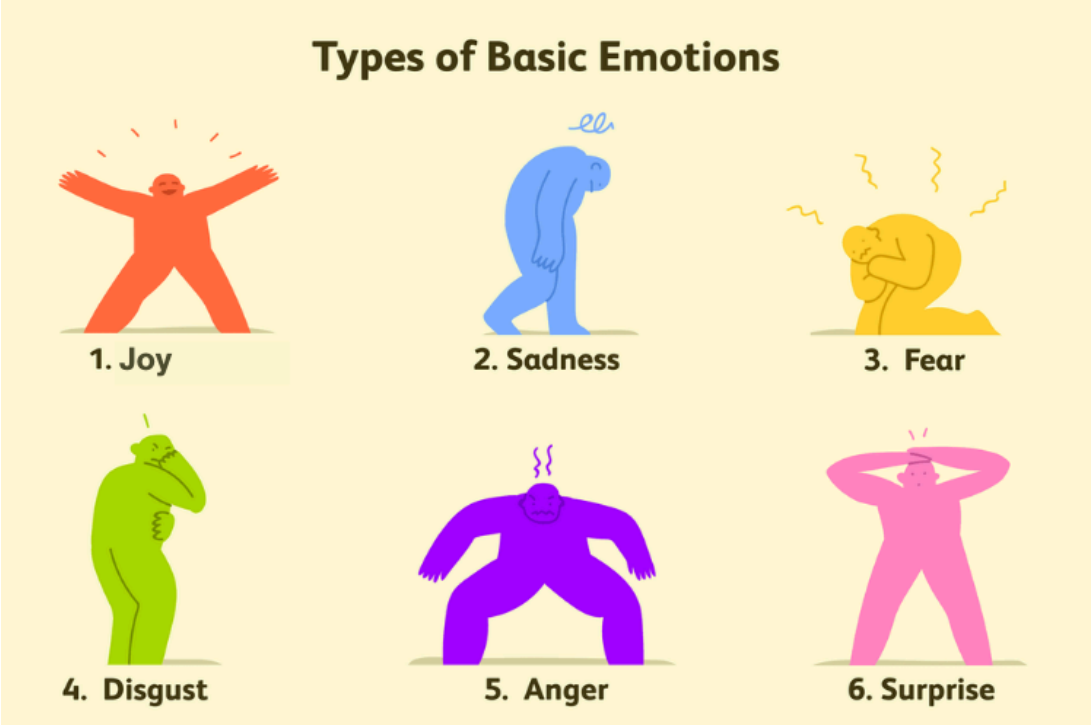
This is the easy part.

Primary emotions are the MAIN emotions that are universal to all and are very easy for everyone to understand.

Think of them like facial expressions.

You can literally make all 6 of these as facial expressions.

Some psychologists say there are more than 6 primary emotions. But for this training, we'll focus on the 6. But if you want more nerdy info, they will be linked here



!!Now this is IMPORTANT to not get confused…

Emotions are universal, ***triggers*** are individual.

Every human knows what fear feels like in their body.

But, what activates that fear is completely different from person to person (which is great for Avatar creation).

And this applies to the other 5 primary emotions as well

Primary emotions for the point of this training have one specific job, and that's to help you be AWARE

2. **Secondary Emotions - Complex combinations that can mean different things to different people**

Secondary emotions are your brain's attempt to label and organize your feelings in a way that is easier for you to understand.

They're like emotional shortcuts, and there are tons of them.

Just know, for the sake of this training, whenever you see a secondary emotion. It's just a sign for you to dig deeper.

So, if someone doesn't specifically state a primary emotion or a version of it, you need to go deeper and unpack it & find out WHY they feel that way.

Examples Of Secondary Emotions:

Anxious → They feel anxious because they likely “fear” a specific experience. Or are future pacing “Sadness” as an outcome that has not happened yet.

Frustrated → They feel frustrated because maybe they felt “joy” in an experience and then that “joy” went away. And now they are going through other experiences to get that “joy” but it is not giving that same “joy”. Or they have a specific desire but can’t attain it so they experience “anger” of things failing which leads to frustration.

Overwhelmed → They feel overwhelmed because they likely "fear" they can't handle all the demands/responsibilities. Or they're experiencing "anger" at having too much put on them with no control over the situation.

Confident → They feel confident because they likely experienced "joy" from past successes in similar situations. Or they have specific evidence/experiences that removed their "fear" about the outcome.

Excited → They feel excited because they're anticipating "joy" from a future experience or outcome. They're future pacing positive emotions that haven't happened yet.

Stressed → They feel stressed because they "fear" the consequences of not meeting expectations/deadlines. Or they're experiencing "anger" at the pressure/demands being placed on them.

Motivated → They feel motivated because they're anticipating "joy" from achieving their goal. Or they "fear" the consequences of NOT taking action, so they're driven to move.

Worried → They feel worried because they "fear" a specific negative outcome. Very similar to anxious - they're future pacing potential loss or "sadness."

Disappointed → They feel disappointed because they experienced "sadness" from unmet expectations. They anticipated "joy" from something that didn't deliver.

Insecure → They feel insecure because they "fear" judgment, rejection, or not being good enough. Or they've experienced "sadness" from past failures that make them doubt themselves.

And there are tons more; you can find even more emotions linked here.

!! IMPORTANT takeaway here is this: The entire goal of understanding emotions is so you can truly understand how someone is feeling, so you know how to speak to them in your ad.

At the end of the day, understand that you can use Emotion as a way to create Avatars on their own. But, the real breakthrough will come when you use emotion to narrow down your avatar further based on their existing desire, experiences, behaviors, and demographics.

Or for a more advanced method, START with the emotion such as “Anxiety,” and narrow it down further to really call out why that person is experiencing that emotion, with desires, experiences, behaviors, demographics.

To help you understand how to do that, let's go ahead and break down some examples here.

Desire Example:
Core Avatar #1: A wants to get a six-pack (Desire-based core avatar)

Core Avatar #2: Feels motivated (Emotion-based core avatar)

Sub Avatar #1: Wants to get a six-pack (Desire), FEELS motivated to get it (emotion)

Sub Avatar #2: Wants to get a six-pack (Desire), FEELS defeated (emotion again)

So again, by leveraging the emotion around the desire, you can create avatars that are more relatable and specific to the desire.

Experience Example:
Core Avatar #1: Has a dog that is pulling (experience-based Core Avatar)

Core Avatar #2: FEELS embarrassed (emotion-based Core Avatar)

Sub Avatar #1: Has a dog that is pulling (Experience) & FEELS embarrassed about the dog pulling (emotion)

Sub Avatar #2: Has a dog that is pulling (Experience) & FEELS scared about the dog pulling (emotions again)

So, by leveraging the emotional piece, you can create avatars that are more relatable and specific to the experience

Demographic Example:
This one is relatively simple.

But again, imagine someone is

Core Avatar #1: 40 years old (demographic-based Core Avatar) *not a great one but will do.*

Core Avatar #2: Feels excited (Emotion-based Core Avatar)

Sub Avatar #1: 40-year-old (demographic) that feels excited (emotion)

Sub Avatar #2: 40-year-old (demographic) that feels extreme anxiety about being 40 (emotion)

Emotion Example

As mentioned above, not all emotions need to be tied to experiences, desires or demographics. You are also able to create avatars using just emotions by grouping people based on just how they feel in general.

However, because most emotions are very broad & non-specific, they are most powerful when combined with desires, experiences, behaviors or demographics that actually caused the emotions.

(This is what makes people feel like you are reading their mind)

The person feels tired (Emotion)

Baby wakes up at 5am because of the morning light in the nursery (Experience)

They want their whole family to have better sleep (Desire)

As you can see here, we started with the emotion that the person feels, which in the beginning can create a lot of relatability.

But as a result of adding in the experience and adding in the desire, it allows us to really hone in on what should be a more effective Sub-Avatar.

Core Avatar #1: They want their whole family to have better sleep (Desire-Based Core Avatar)

Sub Avatar #1: They want their whole family to have better sleep (Desire), but their baby wakes up at 5am because of morning light (Experience), and now the parent feels tired (emotion)

💥 HOW TO CHECK IT'S AN EMOTION💥

Does this describe how a person feels ABOUT or IN RESPONSE to something?

From there, if it is NOT one of the primary 6 emotions, ask WHY and WHAT to really figure out what they are feeling and why.

"I feel motivated" → Why is this person motivated? What specifically is making them motivated?

"I'm anxious" → Why is this person anxious? What specifically is making them anxious?

Category 4: Behaviors & Habits

Behaviors are regular action patterns that people develop as responses to their experiences, emotions, desires, or demographics.

In simple terms, behaviors are how people act.

They are the things that we do, and oftentimes are predictable.

Behaviors are often very specific solutions to problems from experiences:

Experience = "I tried X and Y happened"
Behavior = "So now I do Z instead"

They can also arise as a result of desires:

Desire = "I want X thing"
Behavior = "So now I do Z to try to get it X"

They can come from emotions

Emotion = "I feel anxious around other people"
Behavior = "So now I never go to social events”

And they can even come from demographics

Demographic = "45 year old male"
Behavior = "So now I take testosterone supplements”

The best part about behaviors is that they reveal how someone approaches life, makes decisions, and handles situations.

They are usually core to our beliefs *(which we will break down in the sub-avatars section),* and we do them again, as a result of experiences, desires, demographics, and emotions.

What makes behaviors so powerful is that they are CORE to our self-identity. AKA they are a lot of the time tied to our ego.

Ego: a person's sense of self-esteem or self-importance.

And for the majority of people, they can often do things out of spite just for the sake of “ego” or because “that’s the type of person they are.”

So, when you create ads that target an Avatar's ego, AKA the behaviors that make them who they are, that is where you can create a sense of buy-in that is much, much stronger.

Another thing that makes behavior-based targeting for avatars so strong is the fact that if you understand someone's behaviors, a lot of the time, you can also predict their behaviors.

And so in your ads, you can almost “tell them the future” because based on behavior, you know what that specific type of person is going to do next.

All in all, behaviors are incredibly powerful for avatar building because they directly call out the actions we take, the things we do, and who we are.

Behaviors allow us to show another level of understanding for our Avatars that most people never tap into with marketing, as you have to truly understand who you are marketing to effectively call them out.

Examples Of Some Behaviors

f. Research everything before buying
g. Only shops during sales
h. Avoids crowded gyms
i. Checks email constantly

To help you understand how experiences, emotions, desires, and demographics create behaviors that we can use to narrow down and develop killer avatars, let’s go through some examples

Example #1:

A woman is post-partum, aka just had a baby (Experience + assumed demographic)

The woman now has the desire to lose their post-partum weight. (Desire)

As a result of THE EXPERIENCE and the DESIRE that exists, this person may develop the BEHAVIOR of:

Scrolling Instagram for "mom body transformation" (behavior)

Or they may develop the behavior of

“Doing quick 15-20 minute home workouts” (behavior)

Example #1.5 Behavior:

But here is the cool part…

The post-partum experience may NOT be the only way that someone develops the behavior of *“Doing quick 15-20 minute home workouts”*

That behavior could have been developed from other experiences or desires as well.

Someone may have:

Tried going to the gym during the day, but kept having to leave early to pick up kids (experience)

They want to be known as a person who is in shape (desire)

Now, as a result of that experience & desire, they develop the behavior of:

Doing quick 15-20 minute home workouts (behavior)

So even though the experiences & desires are slightly different, people can develop the SAME behavior.

This information is gold, because you can go “broader” on the Avatar scale by simply targeting the behavior itself

Or you can actually drill down into the behavior with the other 4 categories to create an intense amount of relatability with Sub Avatars..

For the sake of getting you thinking about behaviors and how much more powerful they are for avatar creation, let’s dig into examples.

<u>Experiences That Led To Behaviors Examples:</u>

Experience: Kids threw tantrums in public places
Behavior: Always brings snacks and entertainment when going out with kids

In this instance, again, the experience was that this person's kids were throwing tantrums in public (experience), and this likely created an emotional response; they were embarrassed (emotion), so as a result, they changed what they do, bringing snacks & entertainment (behavior).

✅ **Marketing Example:**
Now, to show you examples of how this can apply to your ads specifically. Let’s mock up some headlines about how we might target this customer:

“Do your kids throw temper tantrums in public?” → Experience-based

“If you never leave the house without snacks for your kids, then…” → Behavior-based

As you can see, we can target 2 core Avatars individually, or again, we can combine them to create a deeper sub Avatar.

Experience: At a crowded gym
Emotion: Has anxiety
Behavior: Only works out at home now

Experience: Dog keeps pulling on walks
Behavior: Only walks the dog at 5 am to avoid crowds

Experience: Currently pregnant with first baby
Behavior: Reads every ingredient label obsessively

<u>Desires That Led To Behaviors Examples:</u>

Desire: Want to lose 20 pounds by summer
Behavior: Meal preps every Sunday for the week

The person has the desire of losing weight for summer (desire - health/status likely) and as a result, developed the behavior of meal prepping every Sunday (behavior).

Now just for extra context, it's important to note that this person likely had an experience that has led to this desire (they saw a jacked guy on Instagram, got made fun of for being pudgy as a kid, etc.) Or the desire could have come from emotions as well (they feel disgusted with how they look in the mirror, they don't feel confident in themselves.)

✅ **Marketing Example:**
Now, to show you examples of how this can apply to your ads specifically. Let's mock up some headlines about how we might target this customer:

"Do you want to lose 20 pounds by summer?" → Desire-based (very broad)

"If you still meal prep every Sunday, then X…" → Behavior-based (more specific)

Again, we can target those 2 core Avatars individually, or we can combine them to create a deeper Sub Avatar.

For an example of how that could look for the Sub Avatar:

"If you're trying to lose 20 pounds in time for summer & you think meal prepping every Sunday will actually work, then X…"

Desire: Want to appear successful and put-together
Behavior: Only buys name-brand items even when generic works

So again, this person has the desire of wanting to appear successful & put together (desire - status or even belonging) and as a result, his behavior is now only buying name-brand items (behavior)

Desire: Want to feel in control of health and future
Behavior: Takes 15+ supplements every morning religiously

<u>Emotions That Led To Behaviors Examples:</u>

Emotion: Feels insecure about their skin
Behavior: Constantly orders new skincare products and serums

Now for emotions, this person FEELS insecure (emotion), and as a result of feeling that way, it has led to them trying every new skincare product and serum (behavior).

✅ **Marketing Example:**
To show you more examples of how this can apply to your ads specifically. Let's mock up some headlines about how we might target this customer:

"If your skin makes you feel insecure…" → Emotion-based (very broad)

"If you constantly order skincare products …" → Behavior-based (more specific)

Again, we can target those 2 core Avatars individually, or we can combine them to create a deeper Sub Avatar.

For an example of how that could look for the Sub Avatar:

"If you're constantly ordering new skincare products because you feel insecure…"

!!Now, I do want to add a note here around Skincare specifically.

When markets get more sophisticated, for example, like skincare, a lot of these types of avatars are already being targeted due to how sophisticated the market is. So, a lot of the time, you have to go deeper and apply more of the 5 core categories (instead of just 1 or 2) to be able to actually relate with someone in these sophisticated markets.

Emotion: Feels happy when people notice her
Behavior: Constantly buys statement pieces

Again, the person FEELS happy (joy) when people notice her (emotion + a bit of an experience & demo), and as a result of feeling that way, it has led to her constantly buying statement pieces so more people notice her (behavior).

Hopefully, now with the examples above, you can see how behaviors not only develop as a result of the other 4 categories, but how they can be used to hone in on your avatar and what they DO.

💥 HOW TO CHECK IT'S A BEHAVIOR/HABIT💥

Does this describe what the person does?

*NOTE it does not have to be a physical action; it can also be mental.

"Constantly overthinking things" is also a behavior

From there, if you want to gauge the strength of the behavior, ask yourself, "How often might they do it?"

The more one does the behavior, the stronger it is, meaning the more relatable it will be.

Category 5: Demographics

Demographics are the relatively static, factual characteristics that define who someone is - things that don't change frequently or at all.

Last but in fact least, we finally make it to everybody's usual favorite for Avatars… Demographics.

Unlike the other 4 categories, Demographics are very straightforward.

As you likely have noticed above, based on desires, experiences, emotions, and behaviors, a lot of the times, demographics are assumed/implied.

Meaning, if someone went through the experience of "Giving birth"

At least for now, only Women can do that.

Therefore, that experience narrows down through demographics as well.

With that said, like the other core categories, demographics can effectively narrow down your Avatars & build more relatability, especially if your product works **better** for people of a specific demographic.

For example, we worked with a brand that sells Skincare for African-American women

Due to these women having melanin-rich skin, they have more specific needs, and this product catered to that.

Therefore, we were effectively able to narrow down avatars and be successful with just demographics.

You also see this with brands such as “Norse Organics” running ads that call out “Moms of 15-year-olds” as an effective strategy.

That said, demographics should NOT be your main differentiator unless you are at much more scale.

On top of that, Demographics drive nowhere near as much purchase motivation as the other 4 categories, so use these if you want to go very specific.

Otherwise, Demographics a lot of the time are not even NEEDED in your avatar-building process.

Crazy, I know.

But the biggest mistake I see so many people make is that they isolate buyers just based on demographics.

A 22-year-old girl and a 54-year-old man could have the same desire (want to find a romantic partner)
They might be going through similar experiences (Not being able to find the right person)
They may feel similar emotions (Have a fear of never being able to find the right person)
And they may even have the same behavior (Using online dating sites)

Yet, as soon as you add a demographic, that can cut people out.

Now again, for a desire this big, experiences, emotions, and behaviors THIS common, sometimes demographics can actually be a great differentiator to help you build more relatability

You’ve likely seen this with apps even:

“Farmers only” dating sites (Kind of crazy but it’s real)

And the reason WHY they do that is because again, it builds relatability.

Here’s the “proof” according to Google.

AI Overview

Farmers Only, the online dating site founded in 2005, was generating a substantial annual revenue that was reported to be as high as **$10 million** in the past. The company, which has a large user base of 1.5 million members, primarily earns revenue through membership fees, selling merchandise, and advertising, according to Medium.

Another great example of this (in the eCom world) is Hollow Socks.

They do over $100k/day (Zach, their founder, is public about it)

And his MAIN avatar is actually based on a specific Employment demographic (Construction workers)

However, he goes deeper and understands their desires, experiences, emotions, and behaviors to be able to target them effectively and scale his brand.

To give you an idea of all the different types of demographics, you can reference the list below.

All Demographics:

j. Gender *(Male/Female/Other)*
k. Birth date/Generation *("90's baby"/Boomer)*
l. Race and Ethnicity *(Latino/Chinese)*
m. Age *(25/65+)*
n. Location *(Canada/British Columbia/Vancouver/Surrey)*
o. Language *(English/French)*
p. Religion *(Christian/Agnostic)*
q. Marital status *(Married/Engaged)*
r. Education *(Diploma/Doctorates)*
s. Employment *(Construction Worker/Entrepreneur)*
t. Income (*$100k per year/ Middle Class/Top 1%)*
u. Disabilities *(Blind/Paralyzed/Deaf)*
v. Health conditions *(Anxiety/Broken Bone/Diabetes)*
w. Height *(5'5 "short" / 6'5 "tall")*
x. Weight *(180lbs/overweight/skinny)*

All in all, just remember demographics should RARELY ever be your starting point for Avatars, as there are much stronger categories.

With that said, they can be great for building that 1 extra bit of relatability.

That said, some are sometimes assumed to have specific desires. (Want my kids to be healthy = Mom/Dad)

💥 HOW TO CHECK IT'S A DEMOGRAPHIC💥

Does it go under one of the categories above?

If not, it's probably not a demographic.

Simple and easy.

What About Beliefs… Category 6?

Now, at one time, while making this document, there was actually a 6th category called:

Beliefs & Values.

With that said, after really going deeper into beliefs specifically. I realized they were not needed as a core avatar building block.

Beliefs are often Experiences, Emotions, & Behaviors tied together.

For Example:

"People who believe they can't lose weight" becomes:

- **Experience:** "Tried multiple diets and gained the weight back."
- **Emotion:** "Feels hopeless about losing weight"
- **Behavior:** "Avoids starting new diets because expects failure"

So, CRUCIAL as beliefs are (and we will get to them in the sub avatar optimization section)

When you catch yourself thinking in terms of beliefs or you spot beliefs in your research during core avatar building, simply ask yourself:

- "What happened to make them believe this?" (Identify the Experience)
- "How does this belief make them feel?" (Identify the Emotion)
- "What do they do because of this belief?" (Identify the Behavior)

This forces you to get more specific and actionable while building your avatars, then you can identify the resulting beliefs later for messaging purposes.

How Many Avatars Should I Make?

This is another great question. Because the truth is, if you ask me, there is no right answer to how many avatars you should have.

With that said, here is how I would recommend from a focus standpoint, how many Avatars you should have:

Stage 1: $0-$100K/Month

If you are $0-$100k you should only have one core avatar that you focus on at a time. Preferably based on a Desire, Experience or Behavior.

But, you will NEED to focus on creating Sub Avatars around that Core Avatar so you can be MORE specific and MORE relatable in the beginning.

The lower the revenue you have, usually the MORE specific you need to be.

As a brand, you EARN the right to go broader.

And so if you are in Stage 1, choose 1 Core Avatar, and focus on creating Sub Avatars of that main Desire, Experience, or Behavior-Based Core Avatar.

For the sake of simplicity, 99% of you should focus on a SINGLE desire-based Core Avatar and build sub avatars around that.

If you want an idea of “What desire” to go after, I would recommend looking at your biggest competitor to see WHAT desire they are scaling with, and simply go deeper on sub avatars so you can

“Out-avatar them”

Rather than “Out-Market them” → Because truthfully, you’re not that good at marketing yet.

Now, if you find yourself stuck and not able to make these sub-avatars work after 2-4 weeks of testing, you can then look to change your Desire-based Core Avatar to a NEW desire.

But just understand, focus and depth compound. The deeper you go, the better you get.

Stage 2: $100K-$1M/Month

At this stage, genuinely, there is not much that changes from an avatar basis.

You should still be focused on one core avatar and specific sub-avatars that can convert better.

Ideally, at this point, you are getting better at marketing, and so you should be able to execute better ads which means you can go after slightly broader avatars.

However, as you get above $500k/month, you will likely want to start looking at adding in an additional Core Avatars (so have 2-3 total) for you to scale further with.

At the point in your brand, you should have enough bandwidth for you and your team to go deep on multiple Core Avatars instead of just 1.

However, we have been able to scale to $1M/month with 1 Core Avatar and great execution.

Stage 3: $1M-$10M/Month

Once you get to the $1M/month mark, this is where avatar creation starts to expand.

And the closer that you get to $10M per month, the broader the Avatars need to be or the more Avatars you need to have (typically a combination of both).

If you have scaled to a $1m+ per month run rate, that usually means you're a good marketer.

However, at this stage to get to $5M+ per month, you and your team need to become GREAT marketers.

At this stage, you also need to start weaponizing New Mechanisms, New Information & TRUE New Identities *(through branding, not Avatar building)*, to convince more people who aren't just buying because it's relatable.

So, the big focus for those of you trying to go from 8 to multi-8 figures, 9 figures is not just being relatable with more avatars (although at this stage usually you have 3-10 Core Avatars)

But, you also need to have world-class execution for those Avatars AND volume.

Again, if we analyze one of the biggest brands actively in DTC actively (Comfrt)

They are maxing out relatability at SCALE.

They generate over 10,000+ pieces of content per week

And even if 10% of them are relatable

That's 1,000 pieces of relatable content being pumped out on repeat.

They have not scaled to $50m/month on accident.

Avatars, Mechanisms *(their weighted hoodies)* Brand *(Supporting mental health)*, Volume *(And a shit load of it)*

Stage 4:$10M+/Month

I touched on this briefly with Comfrt above, but at this stage, you need to be leveraging everything in this document + volume.

But, you are probably in Apex already or are looking to prepare your business for an exit…

So, we can talk about the approach for you more 1-to-1.